ARTIST PROTOCOL

Standard Tattoo

Custom or flash, single session. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake and consent signed. Photo ID 18+ copied. Not intoxicated, pregnant or breastfeeding.

ALLERGY CHECK

Latex, adhesive, ink (red most common), soap, ointment. Numbing: max 4% lidocaine.

SKIN AT SITE

No sunburn, rash, cut or infection. Moles: work around, never over. Keloid history noted.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, bottles, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container in reach ☐ EPA disinfectant, full contact time ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	10 min	Review intake, ID and meds. Confirm design, placement, size and price.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect surfaces, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Razor straight to sharps.
4	**Stencil & approval**	10 min	Client checks placement and spelling in a mirror, then initials.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Firm stretch, steady depth. Wipe with a fresh towel and green soap.
6	**Shading & color**	[ ] min	Shade, then pack color. Change gloves after touching anything off-tray.
7	**Wipe-down**	5 min	Gentle clean with a fresh towel. Check for holidays and blowout. Photos.
8	**Wrap**	5 min	Thin ointment, then plastic wrap or second-skin film as agreed.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Review the page and card. Wrap off in [2–5] h. Explain touch-ups.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect all surfaces.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log ink brand, color, lot #, cartridges and time. Book touch-ups.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Crisp, consistent lines; solid, even fill
- Nothing reused: needle, cap, ink, razor, glove
- Moles and broken skin avoided; no overworking
- Sharps never recapped; container below fill line

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Ink or antiseptic in the eye: flush with eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Seizure: move equipment away, don't restrain, time it. Call 911 if over 5 minutes.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Cartridges (RL/RS/M1)	Machine · voltage
Placement · size	**Numbing product**	**Wrap used**	**Time · initials**